

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3250

Name
Nainika Roy
Email
nainika.roy@columbia.edu
Gender
Female
City, state, and country of residence
New York City
Nationality
USA
When did or will you finish your PhD?
March 2024
University Education
Ph.D. in Neuroscience, Columbia University (Expected March 2024)
M.Phil in Neuroscience, Columbia University, May 2021
B.S. in Molecular and Cellular Biology, Minor in Informatics, University of Illinois at Urbana Champaign, May 2017
What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?
As a Ph.D. student working in translational neurobiology, I am keenly passionate about the advancement of rigorous scientific research and its corresponding progression into clinical applications. I have lived and engaged in scientific work in India, Italy and the United States. This has provided me the unique opportunity to understand the value of a global scientific community and for independent countries to have both strong scientific capacities and access to international research networks. Specifically, I believe that access to a high quality science education can produce generations

of curious and ambitious students, which, in conjunction with adequate infrastructure and resources, can transform the scientific capacity of underserved communities. Events like the COVID pandemic have demonstrated the inequalities in global access to medicine. Fortified scientific capacities in underserved communities, along with an interconnected and inclusive scientific community, will promote independent preparedness for phenomenons such as healthcare emergencies and climate change. Beyond this, access to a robust education will expand opportunities for students from these communities. I am seeking an enriching experience that will broaden my perspective and where I can use my expertise to help achieve worldwide scientific parity; serving as a Science Corps fellow is the perfect avenue for this.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I have been involved with the scientific community in three different continents and I am passionate about teaching pedagogy and promoting curiosity through education. I have taught STEM subjects in underserved schools as a teacher at the Hope Foundation and the National Association for the Blind in Bangalore, India. I have also taught chemistry to high school students in rural Illinois and have done neuroscience classroom visits in New York City. Working with students from different backgrounds has informed my teaching perspective and taught me to adapt my teaching style to best serve my students. Through the Polygence program, I have mentored high school students in developing independent research projects. In line with my desire to promote access to higher education in science for underserved communities, I was a founding organizer of Columbia Access Neuroscience, a program designed to provide guidance, information and opportunities to underrepresented minorities in the United States interested in pursuing graduate research careers. As a scientific editor for Cactus Communications, I provided academic editing services to non-Native English speakers to prevent linguistic barriers from limiting their access to international science. Collectively, I believe these experiences demonstrate my commitment to promoting education and scientific access globally.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In the near future, I am keen on exploring opportunities for science outreach through programs such as Science Corps. Professionally, I will advance my academic career through postdoctoral training. During my postdoctoral training, I intend to further deepen my involvement in outreach and science communication.

In the long term, I see myself performing scientific research, either within academia or in an industry setting. Specifically, I imagine myself leading a research group exploring the mechanistic basis of neurodegenerative disease.

CV/Resume[NR_resume_23.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

I would like to extend my gratitude to this program for allowing academic researchers in STEM to gain global experience and serve communities in need. This program leverages academic skills and can help address unmet needs in underserved communities, while providing access to a global perspective that would greatly benefit scientists and promote empathy and interest in global scientific and medical affairs.

[Science Corps](#)